

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – November 2021-2025 and March – July 2026

Period analysed	March – November 2021-2025 and March – July 2026
Months carrying comments	May 2021 – Jul 2026
Comments collected	7,081
Of which substantive	4,291 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	503 (11.7% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – November 2021-2025 and March – July 2026. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

7,081 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **4,291** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **503 (11.7%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

What the numbers do and don't represent

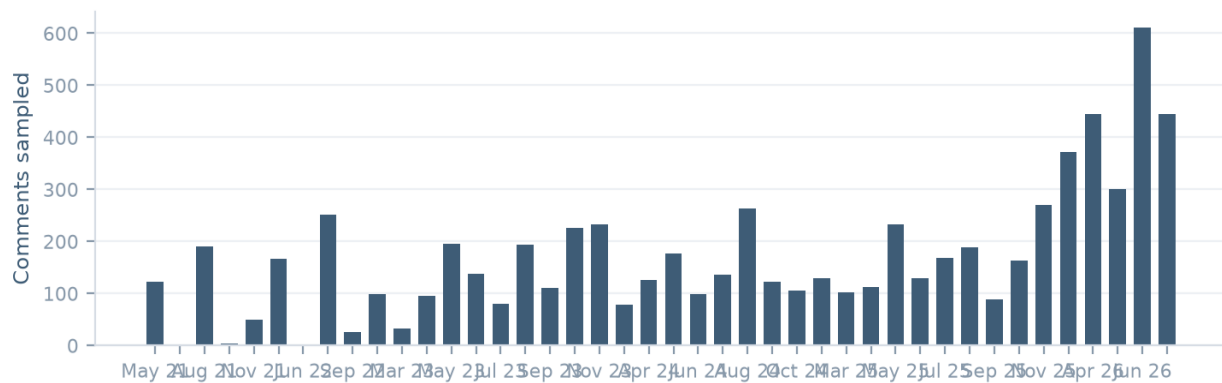
These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

- This document pools the six reporting windows into a single analysis: March-November 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025, plus March-July 2026. Months outside those windows - December, January and February, and August 2026 - are excluded, so this is the six periods analysed together rather than everything ever collected.
- Complaints by period: 2021 28, 2022 66, 2023 56, 2024 70, 2025 92, 2026 191. Volume rises steeply toward the present, so recent years carry this pooled ranking. For a like-for-like comparison across years, use the six period reports, where each period is normalised to its own share.
- Because every window runs March to November, winter is absent by construction. Snow, flooding and storm response therefore sits near the bottom here; in a pool that included December through February it ranks first. Neither figure is wrong - they answer different questions.
- Coverage is uneven across the span. Instagram's public feed could not be paged back past March 2023, so the 2021 and 2022 windows are Facebook-only, while later windows draw on both platforms.
- Facebook history was gathered as date-bounded slices rather than an exhaustive crawl, so each window is a sample of that period rather than every post the city published in it.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts in each window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.

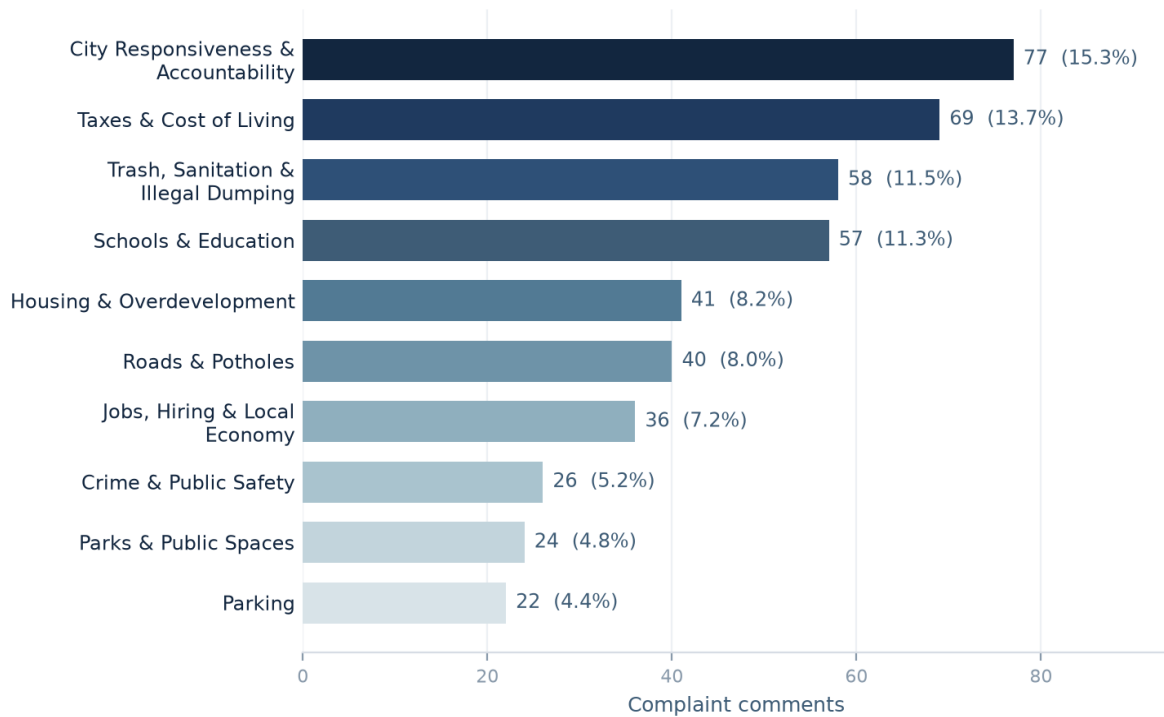
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

City Responsiveness & Accountability is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 15.3% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — City Responsiveness & Accountability, Taxes & Cost of Living, Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping — together make up 40% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

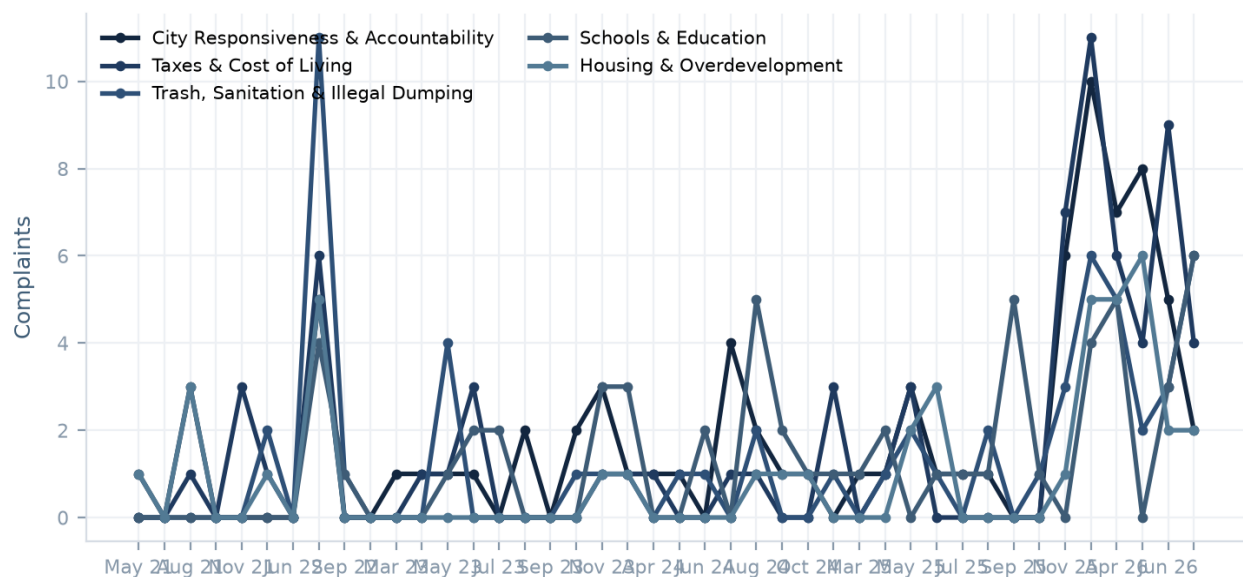


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	77	15.3%	2.3
2	Taxes & Cost of Living	69	13.7%	4.1
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	58	11.5%	1.8
4	Schools & Education	57	11.3%	2.1
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	41	8.2%	2.6
6	Roads & Potholes	40	8.0%	3.6
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	36	7.2%	1.6
8	Crime & Public Safety	26	5.2%	0.4
9	Parks & Public Spaces	24	4.8%	1.8
10	Parking	22	4.4%	1.3

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

City Responsiveness & Accountability

77 complaints · 15.3% of all complaints · Facebook 41 · Instagram 36



"The most corrupt city in New York State. How many members of the Spano Crime Family are profiting from the mayors control. Oh and I heard the mayor is already bribing the city council to give him another term since he can't find another job."

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "This week in Yonkers: Potholes getting filled Cherry blossoms starting to bloom Dispatche..."

"I had the chance of meeting him and we discussed Yonkers as a whole, this was in 2012. He and I talk about changing Yonkers and honestly I thought this guy is all talk and he's just talking bull like most people in office. I feel like he has out did my perception of him, Mayor Spano your doing a fantastic job keep up the good work."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"@— that is correct. The whole council is corrupt too. Sneaky moves are happening behind closed doors - Spano and his council are horrible corrupt individuals."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Did not expect the clock at Yonkers City Hall to look like this ■ Thanks to @mayormikesp..."

"Meanwhile the seniors are still in an unsafe building. Many have stopped going disgusted with all the empty promises and their ignored pleas. The promises made to them for a gazebo by July and a BBQ not fulfilled. We are entering fall. Where is the community in this picture? When will it be about the community? Sadly, it can not be until we have representatives that truly care about the people."

Facebook · 2021 · 12 likes · on: ">■ Grand Opening & Ribbon Cutting| Coyne Park Fitness Station 771 McLean Avenue Yonkers, N..."

2

Taxes & Cost of Living

69 complaints · 13.7% of all complaints · Facebook 47 · Instagram 22



"We need lower property TAX, and better ROADS."

Facebook · 2026 · 14 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"When will the income tax surcharge be eliminated You are bankrupting the citizens of Yonkers"

Facebook · 2025 · 4 likes · on: "Big win for Yonkers! ■■■ We're receiving \$10 million from Governor Hochul's Mid-Hudson M..."

"Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers? Cost of living is ridiculous in this city run by a someone who seems to have most of his family on the payroll"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

"All that Hollywood money pouring in and you still charge a residency tax on every paycheck and a leaving tax when you move out of Yonkers... crooked politicians in a crooked city!"

Facebook · 2025 · 3 likes · on: "Mayor Mike Spano toured the new Mediapro Studios on North Broadway with Robert Halmi the f..."

3

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

58 complaints · 11.5% of all complaints · Facebook 38 · Instagram 20



"Can we have a conversation about how filthy our streets are? Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway look worse than a garbage dump. Please do something."

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes

"If this is true then why aren't summonses given to the apartment buildings and homes that put the recyclables out with the garbage. I see it everyday and watch the sanitation people take it with the garbage. This city doesn't uphold the recycling laws. I want a good answer not an excuse or it being passed on to the next guy"

Instagram · 2023 · 1 likes · on: "On #NationalRecyclingDay, Yonkers takes a stand for a cleaner, greener tomorrow! ■ Our P..."

"They are dumping garbage everywhere. Last week coming home I saw a stack of mattresses on central Avenue. Last year I saw on Facebook that someone dumped a truckload of used tires at a park in Yonkers. Really disgusting"

Facebook · 2022 · on: "■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan..."

"Great now they have to place cameras there. Unfortunately this dumping problem is everywhere. Mr. Spano you have to change those rules at the sawmill River Road sanitation dump site. People from Yonkers are willing to bring garbage there but they don't let them because of those strick rules and regulations. People have no clue where else to dump so that's why they dump everywhere around yonkers."

Facebook · 2022 · on: "Job well done! ■■■..."

4

Schools & Education

57 complaints · 11.3% of all complaints · Instagram 39 · Facebook 18



"GRADUATION RATE!!! Have you ever dealt with Yonkers Board of Education, the biggest pile of trash I've ever seen in my life! Biggest city in Westchester County with the worst school district ever! They don't care about these kids."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"Oh man what would our children's education do without a bunch of pedophiles guiding them while in school. How about paying teachers better and upping security. You people in office are not only a joke but you play dangerous games"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week, @mayormikespano swore in the incredible members of the Mayor's LGBTQ+ Advisory ..."

"Meanwhile the education and safety of student's etc in all of the Yonkers school system SUCKS ■■■■■!!"

Instagram · 2024 · 1 likes · on: "Big news! ■ A cool investment in our children's future: The City of Yonkers and Yonkers P..."

"Oh please. And you wonder a large number of Yonkers Public Schools HS teens have failed at least one class during the 2021-22 school year. Also many vehicles are illegally parked in Yonkers with illegal license plate covers to evade enforcement cameras. #LiberalLogic #Idiocy"

Facebook · 2022 · 2 likes · on: "The New York State Office of Cannabis Management is hosting the "Get Ready, Get Set for Ca..."

5

Housing & Overdevelopment

41 complaints · 8.2% of all complaints · Facebook 26 · Instagram 15



"Why does he have to ask for school funding with all these building projects going up??? Cause our tax dollars are going into their pockets that's why!! Ridiculous to ask for funds should be getting funds from these billionaires putting up these high rises from the developers not tax payers!!! More buildings more traffic more crime more traffic!! But more money in their pockets ■"

Instagram · 2024 · 4 likes · on: "This week's Your Yonkers Now highlights the diversity of Yonkers plus more on the Mayor's ..."

"Hudson piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Is this the building that has been without heat for a year now- tenants are forced to cook with electric hobs. When Con Ed wanted the gas system replaced or would not pass the existing gas lines, without major modifications. Westchester Power should be able to give great rates, even though the landlord let the utilities fall into disrepair it seems"

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "A major investment in Yonkers housing is underway. A \$35 million project at Palisade Tower..."

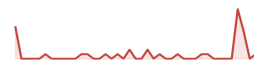
"Mayor stop lying when you have landlords of building raising rent and throwing out tenant because they refuse to pay a 42 % increase"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

6

Roads & Potholes

40 complaints · 8.0% of all complaints · Facebook 24 · Instagram 16



"Fixing potholes? Try paving all streets instead of patching them for years. What a joke"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers, I've heard your concerns. After a tough winter, our crews have already filled ov..."

"Maybe try fixing the potholes, the roads are dangerous."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"How was the winter harsh? Stop spending taxpayers \$\$\$\$\$\$ in other places and fix the ALL the roads. Patching a road isn't considered fixing it, you are just putting a band-aid on it to do less work. #uselesspoliticians"

Facebook · 2021 · 6 likes · on: "The City of Yonkers fills over 3,000 potholes in over 70 different areas in two months!..."

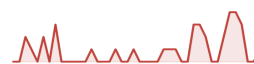
"Hope there is an update when some of these roads are getting paved???"

Instagram · 2024 · 5 likes · on: "Introducing Yonkers-Tron – our sleek new LED display sign on the Government Center Garage ..."

7

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

36 complaints · 7.2% of all complaints · Facebook 21 · Instagram 15



"Where are the jobs? I've been checking since they opened and have never seen them hiring"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "So excited to share the latest Hollywood on Hudson update with all of you! Yonkers isn't j..."

"Let's help kid our kids off the streets. We need summer programs jobs for teenagers. \nWhat's the money in that"

Facebook · 2026 · 11 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Where are the jobs ? Or does your last name have to end with Spano ?"

Facebook · 2025 · 9 likes · on: "Hollywood on Hudson is here! ■ Yonkers just launched a multi-platform ad campaign spotli..."

"Where are the jobs and why do our taxes keep going up"

Facebook · 2025 · 7 likes · on: "Hollywood on Hudson is here! ■ Yonkers just launched a multi-platform ad campaign spotli..."

8

Crime & Public Safety

26 complaints · 5.2% of all complaints · Facebook 13 · Instagram 13



"Police officer Patrick Creegan from 1st precinct is a disgrace to police officers. He is a pervert who exposes himself in public and has sex in his vehicle behind school yards and playgrounds. Sadly that's the bad apple of cops"

Facebook · 2021 · 1 likes · on: "Be A Hero Be the Change Take the Test ..."

"drugs & violence 2 blocks up in several directions Imaoo. what a joke."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"We buy these garbage cans like we did with the ones that require the lids and every week they get stolen either either way you're getting screwed by criminals either it is the city issuing tickets or lowlife stealing the cans.."

Instagram · 2023 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano today joined Yonkers Department of Public Works (DPW) Commissioner Thoma..."

"She never worked that precinct as a cop , how can she be the commanding officer?"

Instagram · 2025 · on: "Today, I joined the Yonkers Police Department in celebrating the promotion of 10 of Yonker..."

9

Parks & Public Spaces

24 complaints · 4.8% of all complaints · Facebook 13 · Instagram 11



“■■ Yonkers parks are dirty and unkept. Trenchard st park is horrible. Unpainted basketball court. Broken glass on the courts and in the grass. Bottles and garbage all over. Broken tree branch's uneven concrete , the list goes on and on. So tell me how you love your parks ????? You should be ashamed you even posted this without looking at your parks.”

Instagram · 2023 · on: “It's #NationalParkWeek ! In Yonkers we■and appreciate our parks! During this week we will...”

“Scottie field needs too be updated like this , the grass is weeds n never cut down , infield dirt is filled with pebbles n rocks no benches for people to sit . No wonder no one plays baseball/softball down there anymore . But at least I have my childhood memories of JFK little league smh”

Facebook · 2025 · on: “Big news at Conor Park: Yonkers' first dog run is officially open! The renovation also br...”

“The park was so much better the way it used to be. The basketball court is nice but other than that, it should've stayed.”

Facebook · 2025 · 14 likes · on: “Welty Park is back and better than ever! Mayor Mike Spano joined community members to cel...”

“It would be nice if something was done for Kingsley Park on Chase Avenue. Many children play there everyday and the playground is rusted which is a health and safety hazard. Also, many people have been asking for a dog park there as well and nothing has been done. The City of Yonkers”

Facebook · 2023 · 6 likes · on: “>■Ribbon Cutting| State-of-the-Art Playscape at the Ridgeway Mixed-Income Residential Comm...”

10

Parking

22 complaints · 4.4% of all complaints · Facebook 15 · Instagram 7



“Ok what about the alternate side parking effects ?”

Facebook · 2021 · on: “Message from Mayor Mike Spano...”

“How about all the post office vehicles taking all the post office parking spots for its customers???”

Instagram · 2025 · on: “Double parking in Yonkers? It's not worth it. ■ In May alone, 3,405 tickets were issued ...”

“Also a lot of trucks parked there. They need to be towed so a sweeper can come by”

Facebook · 2022 · on: “■ Message from Mayor Mike Spano on the illegal dumping that occurs along I-87 Major Deegan...”

“Glenwood Ave between Ravine and Glenwood station is a disaster of double parking on both sides of the street in the afternoons. It's impossible to get through some days. The city would make gobs of \$ if the law were only enforced. Never mind cars parked in NO PARKING areas overnight.”

Instagram · 2025 · on: “Double parking in Yonkers? It's not worth it. ■ In May alone, 3,405 tickets were issued ...”

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	City Responsiveness & Accountability	77	79	15.3%
2	Taxes & Cost of Living	69	81	13.7%
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	58	72	11.5%
4	Schools & Education	57	76	11.3%
5	Housing & Overdevelopment	41	53	8.2%
6	Roads & Potholes	40	45	8.0%
7	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	36	47	7.2%
8	Crime & Public Safety	26	28	5.2%
9	Parks & Public Spaces	24	27	4.8%
10	Parking	22	29	4.4%
11	Homelessness & Quality of Life	18	20	3.6%
12	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	15	19	3.0%
13	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	11	11	2.2%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	9	11	1.8%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.